

TECHNOLOGY

M18 CLAYMORE MINE

Triggered remotely by an electric detonator wire, the Claymore was an antipersonnel mine. Highly lethal, it was used in ambush, often placed alongside Viet Cong trails, and to guard defensive positions such as fighting holes, ready to deliver a fan of 700 spherical steel balls to any enemy combatant who came within 50 yards (46 meters). Scissor-like legs secured it into the ground. In Vietnam, the Claymore was carried by all infantry units. To prevent accidents, "Front toward enemy" was always embossed on the side.



» AFTER

Junction City was ultimately ineffective. The COSVN remained elusive and retaining control of the Iron Triangle proved impossible for the US and its allies.

RETURN OF THE VIET CONG

ARVN forces charged with maintaining security in the Iron Triangle after the initial US assault proved either too small for the task or were simply not up to it, allowing **North Vietnamese and Viet Cong fighters to filter back**. US forces continued to hunt for the COSVN, whose staff increasingly took sanctuary across the border in Cambodia, beyond the reach of American troops.